

Learning Objectives

Learners will be able to:

- Perform initial setup of HCL Notes
- Troubleshoot common issues regarding the setup of HCL Notes
- Reset HCL Notes passwords
- Add databases to a customer's HCL Notes profile

Setting Up HCL Notes

The HCL Notes application, formerly known as IBM Notes, should have an automated setup trigger the first time it is opened on a machine. Occasionally, this gets bypassed, and the user is prompted for a manual setup.

When a customer gets this manual setup prompt, they will contact the IT Service Desk for assistance completing this necessary configuration. It is always recommended to remote over in these cases, if possible, to make the manual setup easier to complete for the customer.

[KBA00062238: HCL Notes - How to Complete First Time Setup or Upgrade](#)

[KBA00177916: IBM Notes - Automated First Time Configuration or Upgrade](#)

Resetting HCL Notes

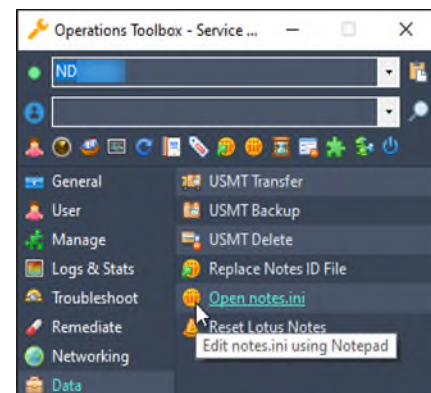
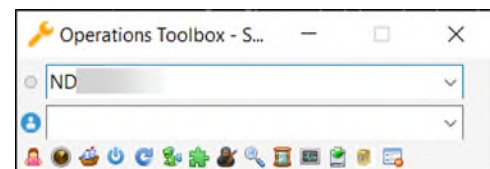
HCL Notes will often error out when the automatic setup is attempted. You may need to reset HCL Notes back to its default settings to complete the manual configuration through the initial setup wizard.

Before performing this step, enter the customer's machine name into the Operations Toolbox.

1. Verify HCL Notes is closed on the customer's machine.
 - a. Click **Data -> Open notes.ini**.

Note: Windows 11 ME machines will require LAPS password when using this feature.

2. In the notepad document that opens, delete all content after the top four (4) lines of the document, keeping the below intact:



[Notes]

KitType=1

Directory=C:\Program Files (x86)\IBM\Lotus\Notes\Data

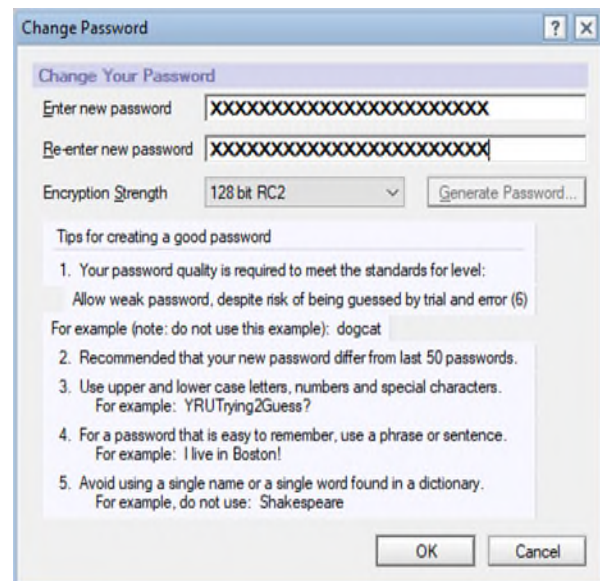
InstallType=6

3. Save the changes and close the **Notes.ini** file.
4. Reopen HCL Notes and the **New Setup Wizard** should appear, allowing you to manually configure the application.
5. If this fails, the **Reset Lotus Notes** option under the same **Data** tab in the Operations Toolbox can be used to trigger the application's automatic setup.

Changing HCL Notes Password

To change the HCL Notes password, the current HCL Notes password must be known. If working in chat, the support resource will take over with the customer to reset the password. If taking calls, to change the customer password after a successful login:

1. Click **File → Change Password**.
2. You will be prompted for your current HCL Notes password.
3. On the **Change Password** screen, enter the **new** password twice.
 - a. When entering a new password, HCL Notes will protect your entry by masking the keys being entered and by adding extra characters to the total count of the password that was created.
 - b. This is normal and to be expected.



4. HCL notes will confirm if password change is successful after clicking **OK**.

Resetting HCL Notes Password

If a phone customer does **not** remember their HCL Notes password:

1. You **must** verify the customer's last four (4) of SSN in PIMS before performing a password reset! This is **required**!

2. Remote over and attempt the default password. Do **not** provide this default password to the customer directly for them to attempt login.
3. Replace the Notes ID file with the Operations Toolbox using the steps described on the following page.
4. If the Operations Toolbox Notes ID replacement fails, contact support resources to start the rebuild process.

[KBA00022725: IBM/HCL Notes - Error - Wrong Password](#)

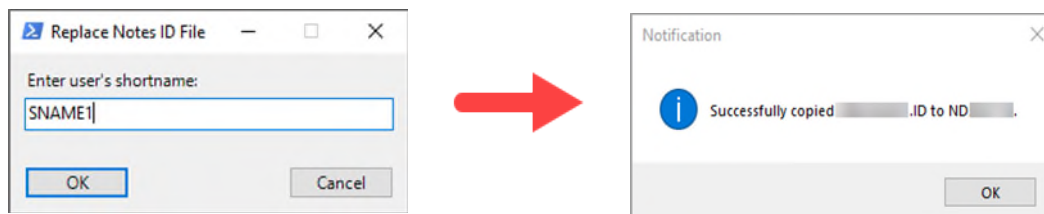
If a chat customer does **not** remember their HCL notes password, phone call verification will be required to resolve the issue. Do **not** resolve password issues through written communications.

Replacing HCL Notes ID File

The HCL Notes ID, which controls the login password to the HCL Notes application, can be obtained from the **Operations Toolbox** if the customer requires a replacement.

Note: The customer's last four of SSN must be verified in PIMS before completing the steps detailed below. This is required!

1. Check **C:\Program Files (x86)\IBM\Lotus\Notes\Data** for Notes ID File if found update to **SHORTNAME.OLD.ID**
2. Access the Operations Toolbox. Input the customer's **AAD/AVD/NH** number.
3. Click **Data > Replace Notes ID File**. Note: on Windows 11 ME Machines this will require LAPS password,
4. Enter the customer's **short name**. This is found under **User Search** in ITS.



5. If successful, this will place a copy of the customer's HCL Notes ID file, set to the default password, on their machine in the required directory. If receiving **Failed to locate ID on the Notes ID server** error:
 - a. Make sure there are no spaces before and after the short name. Copy and paste sometimes picks up blank characters that break the tool.

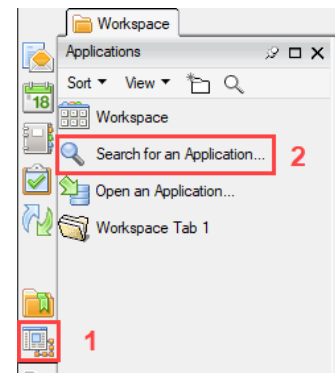
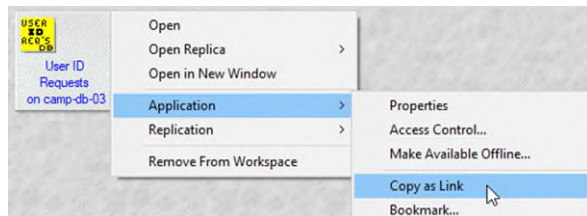
- b. The server is case sensitive. If caps did not work, try all lowercase and vice versa.
6. From here, this replaced version of the HCL Notes.ID file can be utilized to log in successfully with the default password.
 - a. ID files can be in **C:\Program Files (x86)\IBM\Lotus\Notes\Data** if not detected automatically by HCL Notes.
7. Once logged in, the customer **must** update to a new password using the methods described above under the section titled **Changing HCL Notes Password**.

HCL Notes Database Support

Adding a Database

Databases can be added using application search if the customer knows the database name and server.

Alternatively, getting a link from a coworker who already has the database on their desktop may be easier.



[KBA00022541: IBM Notes - How to Add a Database to Your Workspace](#)

If the customer recently received a hotswap or has access to another device with the desired database, all desktop shortcuts can be imported by copying over the desktop8.ndk file in the notes data folder.

[KBA00021019: IBM Notes - How to Back Up IBM Notes Data Files](#)

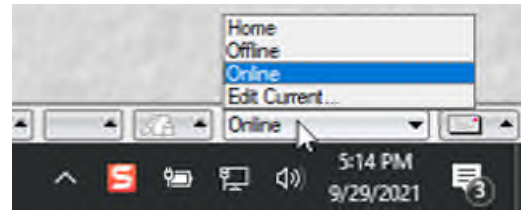
Unable to Access a Database

Database access issues are commonly caused by being logged in with the incorrect id file. Verify customer was prompted for a password when launching HCL notes.

[KBA00022587: IBM Notes - Unable to Access a Database](#)

Another common problem is incorrect setup or location. All HCL notes profiles should have their location set to **Online**.

[KBA00022378: IBM Notes - How to Change the Home/Mail Server and Default Browser](#)



Other Database Problems

Basic support center troubleshooting:

- Is the problem specific to one database?
- Are coworkers having the same issue?

If the issue is present for multiple people on different machines, there is likely an issue with the server or database itself.

[KBA00022667: HCL/IBM Notes - Database is Not Working Properly](#)

[KBA00020728: HCL Notes - Server is Not Responding - Server May be Down or May be Experiencing Network Problems](#)

In some situations, it may be useful to locate the database managers.

